Northwestern

Individual Report for POLI_SCI_403-0_20: Intro Probability & Statistics (Gustavo Diaz)

Project Title: **Course and Teacher Evaluations CTEC Fall 2025**

Courses Audience: **9**
Responses Received: **6**
Response Ratio: **66.7%**

Report Comments

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Creation Date: **Sunday, February 22, 2026**

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Northwestern University

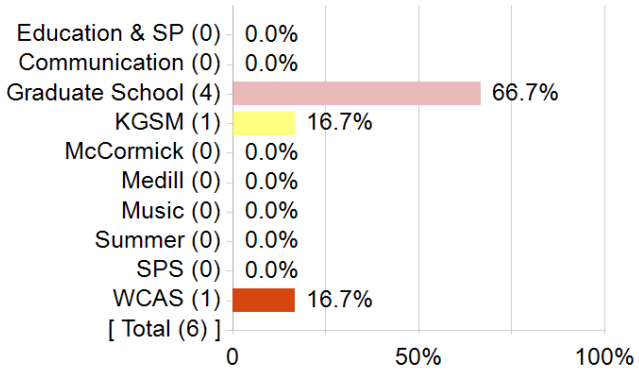
Course Evaluations

Instructor	Course
Gustavo Diaz	**POLI_SCI_403-0_20: Intro Probability & Statistics**

DEMOGRAPHICS

Your School

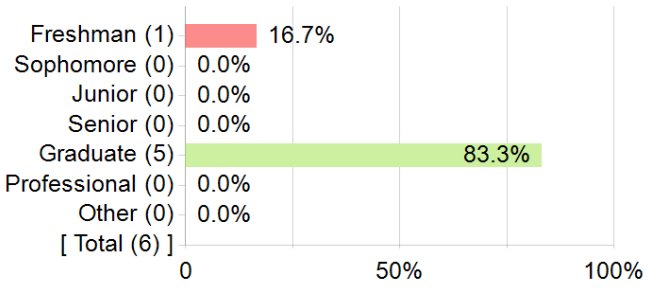
Your School



Options	Count	Percentage
Education & SP	0	0.0%
Communication	0	0.0%
Graduate School	4	66.7%
KGSM	1	16.7%
McCormick	0	0.0%
Medill	0	0.0%
Music	0	0.0%
Summer	0	0.0%
SPS	0	0.0%
WCAS	1	16.7%

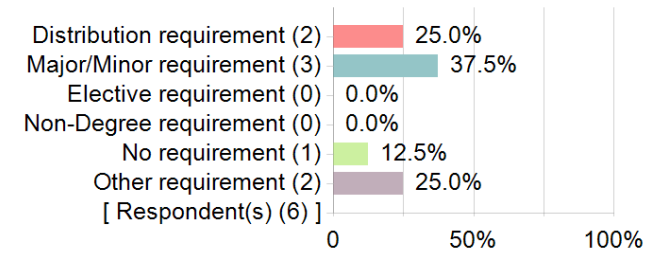
Your Class

Your Class



Options	Count	Percentage
Freshman	1	16.7%
Sophomore	0	0.0%
Junior	0	0.0%
Senior	0	0.0%
Graduate	5	83.3%
Professional	0	0.0%
Other	0	0.0%

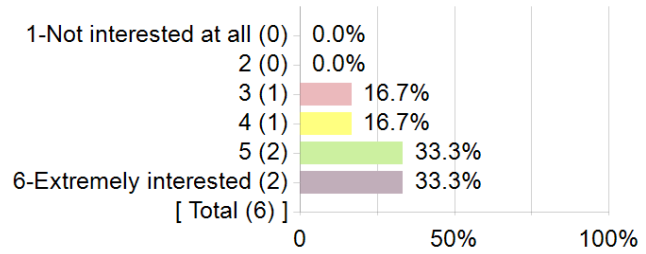
What is your reason for taking the course? (mark all that apply)



Options	Count	Percentage
Distribution requirement	2	25.0%
Major/Minor requirement	3	37.5%
Elective requirement	0	0.0%
Non-Degree requirement	0	0.0%
No requirement	1	12.5%
Other requirement	2	25.0%
Respondent(s)	6	

What was your Interest in this subject before taking the course?

What was your interest in this subject before taking the course?

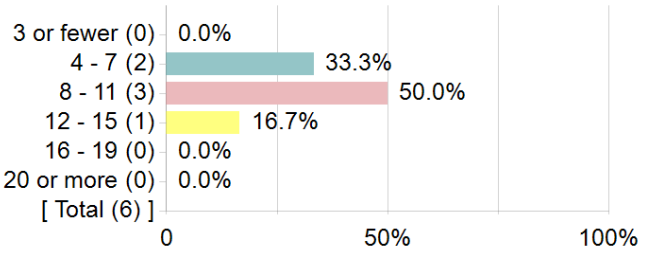


Options	Count	Percentage
1-Not interested at all	0	0.0%
2	0	0.0%
3	1	16.7%
4	1	16.7%
5	2	33.3%
6-Extremely interested	2	33.3%

TIME-SURVEY QUESTION

Estimate the average number of hours per week you spent on this course outside of class and lab time.

Estimate the average number of hours per week you spent on this course outside of class and lab time.

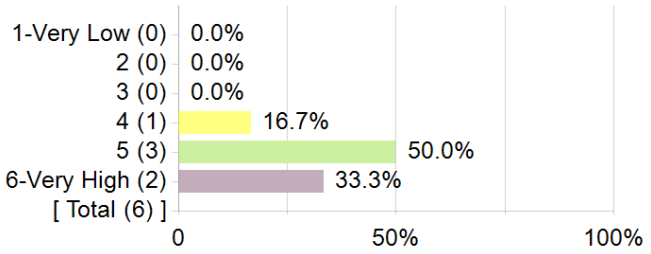


Options	Count	Percentage
3 or fewer	0	0.0%
4 - 7	2	33.3%
8 - 11	3	50.0%
12 - 15	1	16.7%
16 - 19	0	0.0%
20 or more	0	0.0%

COURSE QUESTIONS

Provide an overall rating of the course.

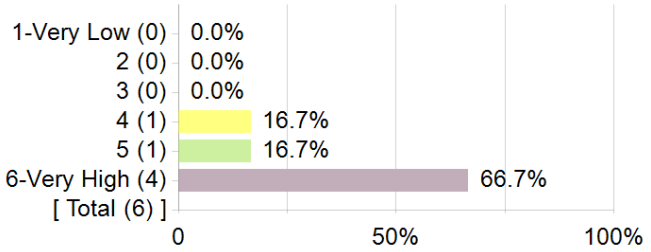
Provide an overall rating of the course.



Options	Score	Count	Percentage
1-Very Low	1	0	0.0%
2	2	0	0.0%
3	3	0	0.0%
4	4	1	16.7%
5	5	3	50.0%
6-Very High	6	2	33.3%
Statistics			Value
Response Count			6
Mean			5.17
Median			5.00
Standard Deviation			0.75

Estimate how much you learned in the course.

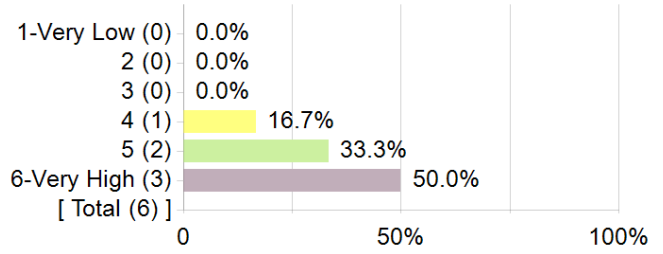
Estimate how much you learned in the course.



Options	Score	Count	Percentage
1-Very Low	1	0	0.0%
2	2	0	0.0%
3	3	0	0.0%
4	4	1	16.7%
5	5	1	16.7%
6-Very High	6	4	66.7%
Statistics			Value
Response Count			6
Mean			5.50
Median			6.00
Standard Deviation			0.84

Rate the effectiveness of the course in challenging you intellectually.

Rate the effectiveness of the course in challenging you intellectually.

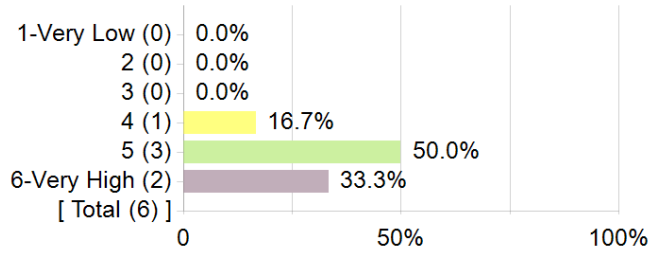


Options	Score	Count	Percentage
1-Very Low	1	0	0.0%
2	2	0	0.0%
3	3	0	0.0%
4	4	1	16.7%
5	5	2	33.3%
6-Very High	6	3	50.0%

Statistics	Value
Response Count	6
Mean	5.33
Median	5.50
Standard Deviation	0.82

Rate the instructional materials (texts, audiovisual materials, etc.) used in this course.

Rate the instructional materials (texts, audiovisual materials, etc.) used in this course.

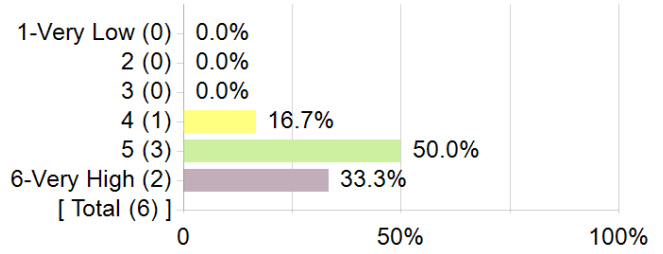


Options	Score	Count	Percentage
1-Very Low	1	0	0.0%
2	2	0	0.0%
3	3	0	0.0%
4	4	1	16.7%
5	5	3	50.0%
6-Very High	6	2	33.3%

Statistics	Value
Response Count	6
Mean	5.17
Median	5.00
Standard Deviation	0.75

Rate how well the overall organization of the course facilitated learning.

Rate how well the overall organization of the course facilitated learning.

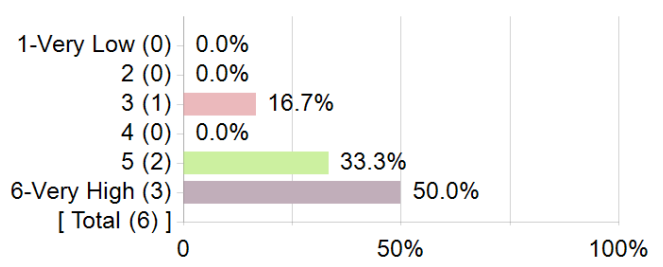


Options	Score	Count	Percentage
1-Very Low	1	0	0.0%
2	2	0	0.0%
3	3	0	0.0%
4	4	1	16.7%
5	5	3	50.0%
6-Very High	6	2	33.3%

Statistics	Value
Response Count	6
Mean	5.17
Median	5.00
Standard Deviation	0.75

Rate how well this course helped you improve your ability to read critically.

Rate how well this course helped you improve your ability to read critically.

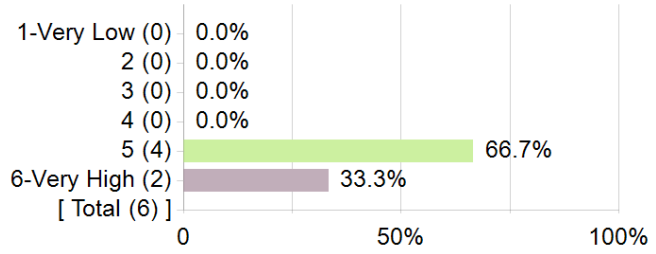


Options	Score	Count	Percentage
1-Very Low	1	0	0.0%
2	2	0	0.0%
3	3	1	16.7%
4	4	0	0.0%
5	5	2	33.3%
6-Very High	6	3	50.0%

Statistics	Value
Response Count	6
Mean	5.17
Median	5.50
Standard Deviation	1.17

Rate how well the examinations accurately measured your achievement in this course.

Rate how well the examinations accurately measured your achievement in this course.

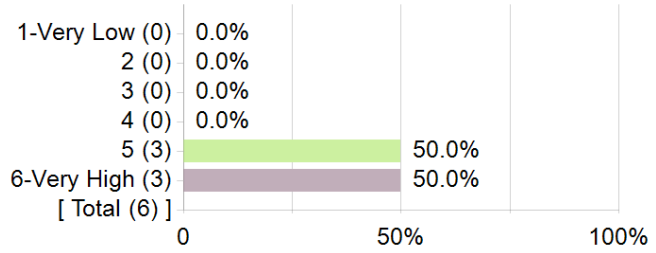


Options	Score	Count	Percentage
1-Very Low	1	0	0.0%
2	2	0	0.0%
3	3	0	0.0%
4	4	0	0.0%
5	5	4	66.7%
6-Very High	6	2	33.3%
Statistics			Value
Response Count			6
Mean			5.33
Median			5.00
Standard Deviation			0.52

INSTRUCTOR QUESTIONS

Provide an overall rating of the instruction.

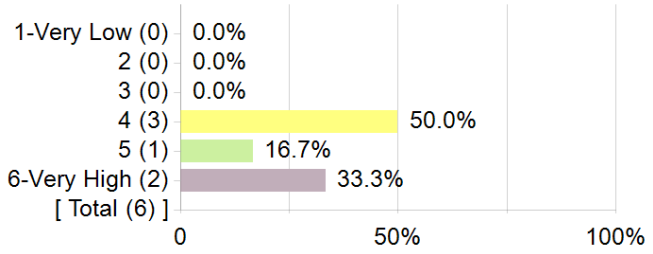
Provide an overall rating of the instruction.



Options	Score	Count	Percentage
1-Very Low	1	0	0.0%
2	2	0	0.0%
3	3	0	0.0%
4	4	0	0.0%
5	5	3	50.0%
6-Very High	6	3	50.0%
Statistics			Value
Response Count			6
Mean			5.50
Median			5.50
Standard Deviation			0.55

Rate the effectiveness of the instructor in stimulating your interest in the subject.

Rate the effectiveness of the instructor in stimulating your interest in the subject.

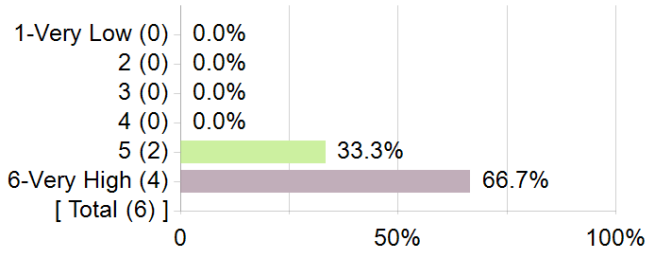


Options	Score	Count	Percentage
1-Very Low	1	0	0.0%
2	2	0	0.0%
3	3	0	0.0%
4	4	3	50.0%
5	5	1	16.7%
6-Very High	6	2	33.3%

Statistics	Value
Response Count	6
Mean	4.83
Median	4.50
Standard Deviation	0.98

Rate how well the instructor identified the important concepts in the course.

Rate how well the instructor identified the important concepts in the course.

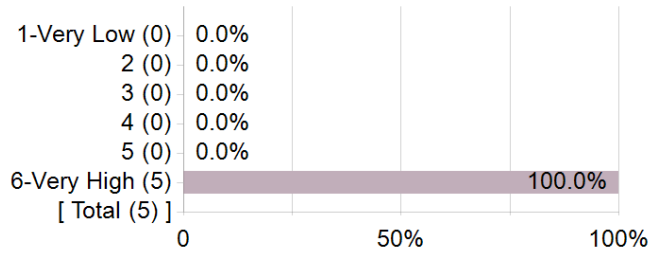


Options	Score	Count	Percentage
1-Very Low	1	0	0.0%
2	2	0	0.0%
3	3	0	0.0%
4	4	0	0.0%
5	5	2	33.3%
6-Very High	6	4	66.7%

Statistics	Value
Response Count	6
Mean	5.67
Median	6.00
Standard Deviation	0.52

Rate how well prepared the instructor was for the class.

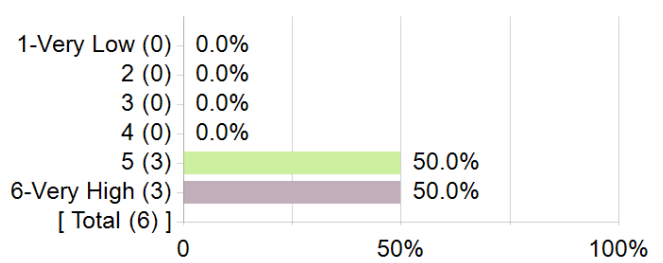
Rate how well prepared the instructor was for the class.



Options	Score	Count	Percentage
1-Very Low	1	0	0.0%
2	2	0	0.0%
3	3	0	0.0%
4	4	0	0.0%
5	5	0	0.0%
6-Very High	6	5	100.0%
Statistics			Value
Response Count			5
Mean			6.00
Median			6.00
Standard Deviation			0.00

Rate the effectiveness with which the instructor communicated course content and ideas.

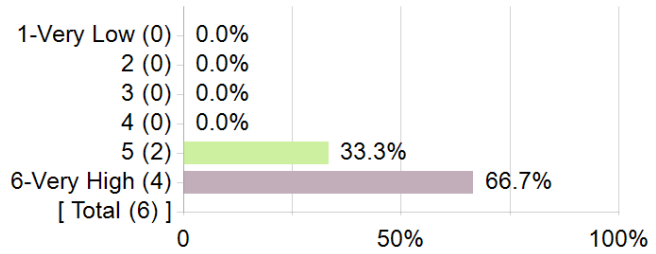
Rate the effectiveness with which the instructor communicated course content and ideas.



Options	Score	Count	Percentage
1-Very Low	1	0	0.0%
2	2	0	0.0%
3	3	0	0.0%
4	4	0	0.0%
5	5	3	50.0%
6-Very High	6	3	50.0%
Statistics			Value
Response Count			6
Mean			5.50
Median			5.50
Standard Deviation			0.55

Rate the instructor's enthusiasm in teaching this class.

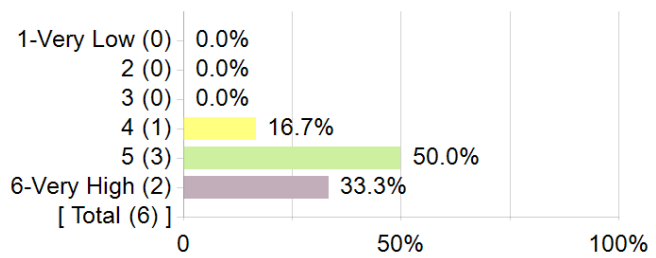
Rate the instructor's enthusiasm in teaching this class.



Options	Score	Count	Percentage
1-Very Low	1	0	0.0%
2	2	0	0.0%
3	3	0	0.0%
4	4	0	0.0%
5	5	2	33.3%
6-Very High	6	4	66.7%
Statistics			Value
Response Count			6
Mean			5.67
Median			6.00
Standard Deviation			0.52

Rate how well the instructor motivated you to do your best work.

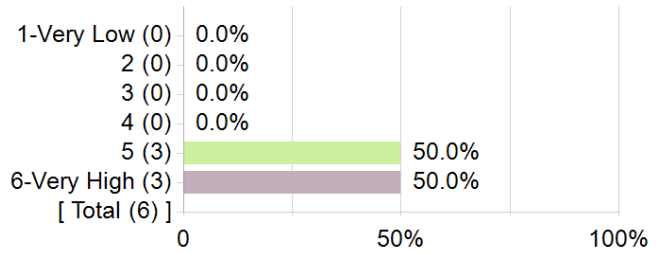
Rate how well the instructor motivated you to do your best work.



Options	Score	Count	Percentage
1-Very Low	1	0	0.0%
2	2	0	0.0%
3	3	0	0.0%
4	4	1	16.7%
5	5	3	50.0%
6-Very High	6	2	33.3%
Statistics			Value
Response Count			6
Mean			5.17
Median			5.00
Standard Deviation			0.75

Rate how well the instructor encouraged you to think for yourself.

Rate how well the instructor encouraged you to think for yourself.

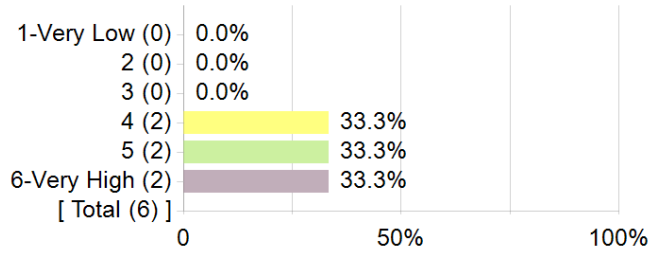


Options	Score	Count	Percentage
1-Very Low	1	0	0.0%
2	2	0	0.0%
3	3	0	0.0%
4	4	0	0.0%
5	5	3	50.0%
6-Very High	6	3	50.0%

Statistics	Value
Response Count	6
Mean	5.50
Median	5.50
Standard Deviation	0.55

Rate how well the instructor taught you how to recognize good arguments in this field.

Rate how well the instructor taught you how to recognize good arguments in this field.

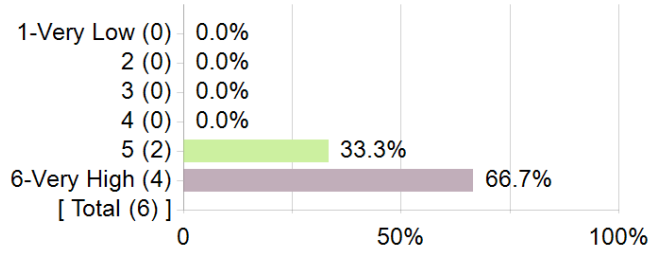


Options	Score	Count	Percentage
1-Very Low	1	0	0.0%
2	2	0	0.0%
3	3	0	0.0%
4	4	2	33.3%
5	5	2	33.3%
6-Very High	6	2	33.3%

Statistics	Value
Response Count	6
Mean	5.00
Median	5.00
Standard Deviation	0.89

Rate how well the instructor presented class lectures in an organized fashion.

Rate how well the instructor presented class lectures in an organized fashion.



Options	Score	Count	Percentage
1-Very Low	1	0	0.0%
2	2	0	0.0%
3	3	0	0.0%
4	4	0	0.0%
5	5	2	33.3%
6-Very High	6	4	66.7%

Statistics	Value
Response Count	6
Mean	5.67
Median	6.00
Standard Deviation	0.52

OPEN-ENDED QUESTIONS

Did the course help you learn? Why or why not?

Comments

The instructional and lab materials were thorough and Gustavo was always available to help.

Yes. The low rating in "reading critically" is because that's not exactly what stats teaches, but overall, course helped a lot.

The course helped provide guidance to continue independent study and reading on basic principles of statistics, as well as a brief introduction to experimental social science. This course has been very informative and thought provoking.

The instructor simplified the guidelines and took practical steps to teach what he actually does as a researcher, with a lot of transparency. He and his TA were both personally engaged with me as a student. Overall, this course was very helpful.

Please summarize your reaction to this course focusing on the aspects that were most important to you.

Comments

Compacting graduate–level statistical concepts and their computation in R into a ten week instructional course isn't a simple feat, but Gustavo managed this exceptionally well. He didn't overwhelm students with many supplemental readings beyond the chapters assigned from the textbook, allowed ample time for questions in class, and invested a lot of time helping us develop our final project ideas.

Things were a bit crammed for time at certain points, especially in the lab periods, which were too short for all the material we were planning to get through in the lab.

I dove into statistics knowing very little and remembering very little from undergrad and highschool. I came out somewhat enlightened about how logic can be extended and implemented through computer code.

This course, alongside careful independent study and extracurricular work using my own data, has been incredibly helpful in teaching practical steps for transparency, replicability, and rigor as a researcher. It truly ignited a passion for understanding in depth how research practices can be made more open and trustworthy.

What are the primary teaching strengths of the instructor?

Comments
His material is very well organized every week and he always shows the R–equivalent computation of whatever concept we're learning about. He also selected a great introductory–level textbook for this course that didn't feel intimidating to read.
Professor Gustavo is effective at tailoring content to the specific needs for which students take the class. He knows that we're looking first and foremost for practical guidance in poli sci methodology, not theoretical abstractions, so we focus on that.
Gustavo is organized and has built a network of knowledge in his GitHub repository that guides students in conducting rigorous, transparent, and replicable research projects from start to finish. His teaching style emphasizes practicality, which is something I deeply respected in his work. He offered guidance whenever I asked, and his TA did as well.

What are the primary weaknesses, if any, of the instruction?

Comments
Nothing specific to the instructor.
None in particular.
I do not have much to add beyond praising his teaching, because at Gustavo's level people are usually most aware of their own faults.

Can you offer suggestions for improvement?

Comments
Because the material is dense and compacted, especially for those without much quantitative background, more class time should be dedicated to the in–slides statistical concepts instead of reviewing the previous lab assignment. Any comments or questions from the lab should be inferred from feedback on Canvas or be directed to the TA. When applicable, unnecessary questions from students should be ignored more often as to not disturb the learning process for the rest.
Doing math in the 9 AM time slot is tough, but that's just the way the schedule worked out.
I cannot offer any concrete suggestions.